

Marsanes

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X,1,1–68,18

[...] and a [reward]. They [came to know]; they found him with a pure heart, (and) they are not afflicted by him with evils. Those who have received you (pl.) will be given their choice reward for endurance, and he will ward off [the] evils from them. [But] let none of us be distressed [and] think [in] his heart that the great Father [...]. For he looks upon the All [and] takes care of them all. And [he] has shown to them his [...]. Those that [...] at first.

But as for the thirteenth seal, I have established it, together with [the] summit of knowledge and the certainty of rest. The first [and the] second and the [third] are the worldly and the material. I have [informed] you concerning these, that you should [...] your bodies. And [a] sense-perceptible [power] will [...] those who will rest, and they will be kept [from] passion and division [of the] union.

The fourth [and the] fifth which are above, [these] you have come to know [... divine]. He exists after the [...] and the nature of the [...] that is, the one who [...] three. And [I have informed] you of [...] in the three [...] by these [two. I have informed] you concerning [it, that it] is incorporeal [...] and after [...] within [...] every [...] which [...] your [...]. The [fifth, concerning the] conversion [of] those that are within me, and concerning those who dwell in that place.

But the sixth, concerning the self-begotten ones, concerning the incorporeal being which exists partially, together with those who exist in the truth of the All [...] for understanding and assurance. And the [seventh], concerning the self-begotten power, which [is the] third [perfect ...] fourth, concerning salvation [and] wisdom. And the eighth, concerning the mind which is [male, which] appeared [in the beginning], and (concerning) the being [which is incorporeal] and the [intelligible] world. The ninth, [...] of the power [which] appeared [in the beginning. The] tenth, [concerning Barbelo, the] virgin [...] of the Aeon. [The eleventh] and [the twelfth] speak of the Invisible One who possesses three powers and the Spirit which does not have being, belonging to the first Unbegotten (fem.). The thirteenth speaks concerning [the] Silent One who was not [known], and the primacy of [the one who] was not distinguished.

For I am he who has [understood] that which truly exists, [whether] partially or [wholly], according to difference [and sameness], that they exist from the [beginning in the] entire place which is eternal, <i.e.) all those that have come into existence whether without being or with being, those who are unbegotten, and the divine aeons together with the angels, and the souls which are without guile, and the soul-garments, the likenesses of [the] simple ones. And [afterwards they] have been mixed with [...] them. But still [... the] entire being [...] which imitates the [incorporeal being] and the unsubstantial (fem.). [Finally] the entire defilement [was saved] together with the immortality of the former (fem.). I have deliberated and have attained to the boundary of the sense-perceptible world, <I have come to know) part by part the entire place of the incorporeal being, and <I) have come to know the intelligible world. <I have come to know), when <I) was deliberating whether in every respect the sense-perceptible world is [worthy] of being saved entirely.

[For] I have not ceased speaking [of the] Self-begotten One, O [...]. [...] became [...] part by part the entire place. He descended; again he descended <from) the Unbegotten One who does not have being, who is the Spirit. That one who exists before all of them reaches [to the divine] Self-engendered One. The one having [being] searches [...] and he exists [...] and he is like [...] and from [...] dividing [...] I became [...] for many, as it is manifest that he saved a multitude.

But after all of these things I am seeking the kingdom of the Three-Powered One, which has no beginning. Whence did he appear and act to fill the entire place with his power? And in what way did the unbegotten ones come into existence, since they were not begotten? And what are [the] differences among the [aeons? And] as for those who are unbegotten, how many [are they]? And in what respect [do they differ] from each other?

When I had inquired about these things I perceived that he had worked from silence. He exists from the beginning among those that truly exist, that belong to the One who exists. There is another, existing from the beginning, belonging to the One who works within the Silent One. And the silence [...] him works. For as much as this one [...] that one [works from] the [silence which belongs to the] Unbegotten One among [the aeons, and from] the beginning he does not have [being]. But the energy of that One the Three-Powered One, the One unbegotten [before] the Aeon, not having [being]. And it is possible to behold the supremacy of the silence of the Silent One, i.e. the supremacy of the energy of the Three-Powered. And the One who exists, who is silent, [who is] above the [heaven ...], revealed [the Three-Powered, First]-Perfect One.

[When he ...] to the powers, they rejoiced. Those that are within me were perfected together with all the rest. And they all blessed the Three-Powered, one by one, who is [the] First-Perfect One, [blessing] him in purity, [everywhere] praising the Lord [who exists] before the All, [...] the Three-Powered. [...] their worship [...] myself, [and I will still go on inquiring] how they had become silent. I will understand a power which I hold in honor.

The third power of the Three-Powered, when it (fem.) had perceived him, said to me, "Be silent in order that you might know; run, and come before me. But know that this One was [silent], and obtain understanding." For [the power] is attending [to me, leading] me into [the Aeon which] is Barbelo, [the] male [Virgin].

For this reason the Virgin became male, because she had been divided from the male. The Knowledge stood outside of him, because it belongs to him. And she who exists, she who sought, possesses (it), just as the Three-Powered One possesses. She withdrew from them, from [these] two [powers], since she exists [outside of] the Great One, as she [...] who is above [...] who is silent, [who has] this [commandment] to be silent. His knowledge and his hypostasis and his activity are those things of which the power of the Three-Powered spoke, <saying), We all have withdrawn to ourselves. We have [become] silent, [and] when we came to know [him, that is], the Three-Powered, [we] bowed down; we [...] we] blessed him [...] upon us." [...].

[... the] invisible [Spirit] ran up to his place. The whole place was revealed; the whole place unfolded <until) he reached the upper region. Again he departed; he caused the whole place to be illuminated, and the whole place was illuminated. And [you] (pl.) have been given the third part of [the spirit] of the power of the One [who possesses] the three [powers]. Blessed is [...]. He said, "O [you who dwell in these] places, it is necessary [for you to know] those that are higher than these, and tell them to the powers. For you (sg.) will become [elect] with the elect ones [in the last] times,

[as] the invisible Spirit [runs] up above. And you [yourselves], run with him [up above], since you have [the] great crown which [...].

But on the day [...] will beckon [...] run up above [...] and the sense-perceptible [...] visible [...] and they [...]"

(pp. 11–12 missing)

... the perception. He is forever, not having being, in the One who is, who is silent, the One who is from the beginning, [who] does [not] have being [...] part of [...] indivisible. The [...] consider a [... ninth ...]

[...] [was dwelling] among the aeons which have been begotten. As I was permitted, [I] have come to be among those that were not [begotten]. But I was dwelling in the [great] Aeon, as I [...]. And [...] the three powers [...] the One who [possesses] the [three] powers. The [three powers ... the] Silent One and the Three-Powered One [...] the one that does not have breath. We took our stand [...] in the [...] we entered [...] breath [...] who does not have breath, [and he] exists in a [... completely]. And I saw [...] him to the great (fem.) [...] they knew [him ...] limit [...] and [I ...] alone [...] is active [...] why, [again], (does) knowledge [...] ignorant, and [...] he runs the risk [...] that he become [...] on account of [...]. Those [...]. But it is necessary that a [...] does not have form [...] to this one [...] exists before [...] the thought [...] from] the beginning [...] the one that [...] these [...] look(ed) at [...] in nine [...] the cosmic hebdomad [...] in a day of [...] forever [...] and [...] after] many [years ...] when I saw the [Father I came to] know him, and [...] many [...] partial [...] forever [...] the material ones [...] worldly [...] above [...] in addition [...]

... he [...] out of [...] into those that [...] them into [...] name them. And (as for) their nomenclature, [bear] witness yourselves [that you are] inferior to [their ...] and their [hypostasis].

But [in addition, when ...] hidden [...] the third [power]. The blessed Authority (fem.) said [...] among these and [...] i.e. she who [does not have ...]. For there is not glory [...] nor even the one who [...]. For indeed the one who [...]. For [...]

... and the [signs of the Zodiac ...] and the [...] and [...] which do not have [...] acquire for [...] revolution ...]. But [the] soul(s) [...] there [...] body(s) of this [...] soul(s) of heaven [...] around [...] shape [...] which is [...]

... those that [...] there [...] all the likenesses [...] them [...] all the forms [...] shape(s), so that [they ... and] become [...] themselves [...] and the [...] the animals [...] and the [...]

(pp. 23–24 missing)

... there.

But their powers, which are the angels, are in the form of beasts and animals. Some among them are [polymorphous], and contrary to [nature] they have for their names which [...]. They are [divided] and [...] according to the [...] and [...] in [form ...]. But these that are [aspects] of sound according to the third originate from being. And concerning these, all of these (remarks) are sufficient, since we have (already) spoken about them.

For [this] division takes place again in these regions in [the manner] we have mentioned from the [beginning]. However the soul, on the other hand, [has] different shape. ~~The shape of the soul exists [in this] form, i.e. (the soul) that came into existence of its own accord. The shape is [the second] spherical part while the first allows [it], ceiou, the self-begotten soul, acciouo. [The] second~~

~~schema, eeiou, ... by those [having] two sounds (diphthongs), the first being placed after them [...] the light.~~

~~[Control] yourselves, receive [the] imperishable seed, bear fruit, and do not become attached to your possessions.~~

~~But know that the oxytones exist among the vowels and the diphthongs which are next to them. But the [short] are inferior, and the [...] are [...] by them. Those that [...] since they are intermediate [...]. The sounds of [the semivowels] are superior to the voiceless (consonants). And those that are double are superior to the semivowels which do not change. But the aspirates are better than the inaspirates of the voiceless (consonants). And those that are intermediate will [accept] their combination in which they are; they are ignorant [of] the things that are good. They (the vowels) are combined with the [intermediates] which are less. [Form] by [form], <they constitute> the nomenclature of the [gods] and the angels, [not] because they are mixed with each other according to every form, but only (because) they have a good function. It did not happen that (their) will was revealed.~~

~~Do not keep on [sinning], and do not dare to make use of sin. But [I] am speaking to you (sg.) [concerning the three ... shapes] of the soul. [The] third [shape of the soul] is [...] is a spherical one, put after it, from the simple vowels: eee, iii, ooo, uuu, ooo. The diphthongs were as follows: ai, au, ei, eu, eu, ou, ou, oi, ei, ui, oi, auei, eueu, oiou, ggg, ggg, ggg, aiau, [eieu], eu, oiou, ou, ggg, [ggg] > aueieu, oiou, eu, three times for a male soul. The third shape is spherical. The second shape, being put after it, has two sounds. The male soul's third shape (consists) of the simple vowels: aaa, eee, eee, iii, ooo, uuu, 000, 000, 000. [And] this shape is different [from] the first, but [they resemble] each other [and they] make some [ordinary sounds] of [this sort: ace]oo. And from these (are made) the diphthongs.~~

~~So also the fourth and the fifth. With regard to them, they were not allowed to reveal the whole topic, but only those things that are apparent. You (pl.) were taught about them, that you should perceive them in order that they, too, might all seek and find [who] they are, either by themselves alone [...] or by each other, or to reveal [destinies] that have been determined from the beginning, either with reference to themselves alone [or] with reference to one another, just as [they] exist with each other [in] sound, whether partially or formally.~~

~~[They are] commanded [to] submit or their [part] is generated and formal. Either (they are commanded) by [the long] (vowels) or [by] those of [dual time value, or] by [the short (vowels)] which are small [...] or the oxytones or the intermediates or the barytones. And <the> consonants exist with the vowels, and individually they are commanded, and they submit. They constitute the nomenclature [of] the angels. And [the] consonants are self-existent, [and] as they are changed submit to the hidden gods by means of beat and pitch and silence and impulse. [They] summon the semivowels, all of which submit to them with one [accord]; since it is only the [unchanging] double (consonants) that coexist with the semivowels.~~

~~But the aspirates [and the inaspirates] and the [intermediates] constitute [the voiceless (consonants)]. Again ... they] are combined [with each other, and] they are separate from one another. They are commanded, and they submit, and they constitute an ignorant nomenclature. And they become one or two or three or [four] or five or six up to seven having a [simple] sound, (together with) these which [have] two [sounds], ... the place [of the seventeen consonants. Among] the first~~

names [some] are less. And since [these] do not have being, either [they] are an aspect [of] being [or] they divide the nature [of] the mind which [is masculine] (and) which is [intermediate].

And you (sg.) [put] in those that resemble each other [with] the vowels [and] the consonants. Some are: bagadazatha, begedezethe, [begede]zethe, [bigidizithi, bogo]dozotho, [buguduzuthu], bogodozotho. [And] the rest [...] ba[bebebibobubo]. But the rest are different: abebibi'bob, in order that you (sg.) might [collect] them, and be separated from the angels.

And there will be some effects. The first (fem.), which is good, is from [the] triad. It [...] has need of [...] their shapes. dyad and the monad do not resemble anything, but they are first to exist. The dyad, being divided, is divided [from the] monad, [and it] belongs to the hypostasis. But the tetrad received (the) [elements], and the pentad received concord, and the [hexad] was perfected by itself. The [hebdomad] received beauty, [and the] ogdoad [received ...] ready [...] greatly. And the [decad revealed] the whole place. But the eleven and the [twelve] have traversed [...] not having [...] it [is higher ...] seven [... name(s) ...] promise that [...] begin [to separate] them by means of a mark [and] a point, the [one which quarrels] from the one which is [an enemy].

Thus [...] of being [...] the [letters ...] in [a holy] or according to a [bond] existing separately. [And] exist with each [other] in generation or [in birth. And] according to [...] generation] they do not have [...] these [...] one [...] speaking [the] riddle.

Because within [the] sense perceptible world there exists the temple [which measures] seven hundred [cubits], and a river which [...] within [... for] ever, they [...] three [...] to the four [...] seals [...] clouds [and the] waters, and the [forms of the] wax images, [and] some emerald likenesses.

For the rest, I will [teach you (sg.)] about them. This is [the] generation of the names. That (fem.) which [was not] generated [... from the] beginning [...] with regard to [...] time(s), when [confined], when spread out, when [diminished]. But there exists the gentle [word], and there exists another word which [approaches] being [...] in this [manner ...]. And he [...] the difference [...] and the [...] the all and a [...] the [undivided] beings and the power [...] having [a] share in [the joy] separately and [...] whether [...] power [... he] exists [in] every place [...] them always. [He] dwells with the corporeal and the incorporeal ones. This is the word of the hypostases that one should [...] in this way. If [...] with their [...] helping [those who stir up] the [...] manifest [...] if one knows him, he will [call] upon him.

But there are words, some of which are [two but others] existing [separately ... and] they [...] or those which [...] or according to [those that] have duration. And [these] either are separate from [them] or they are joined to one another, or with themselves, either [the] diphthongs, or the simple [vowels], or every [...] or [...] or [...] exist just as [...] exist [...] the [consonants ...] they exist individually until they are divided and doubled. Some have the power [...] according to the [letters that are consonants ...] become [...] by themselves [...] and three (times) [for the] vowels, and twice [for] the consonants, [and] once for the entire place, and with ignorance for [those which] are subject to change [...] which] became [...] together with the [entire place ...] finally.

And [...] they all [...] hidden, but they were pronounced openly. They did not stop without being revealed, nor did they stop without naming the angels. The vowels [join] the [consonants, whether] without [or] within, [...] they said [... teach you (sg.) ...] again [for ever. They were counted] four times, (and) they were [engendered] three times, and they became [...].

For these reasons we have acquired sufficiency; for it is fitting that each one acquire power for himself to bear fruit, and that we never cast aspersions [on] the mysteries [...] the [...].

For [...] which [is ... the] souls [...] [the] signs of the Zodiac [...] a new hypostasis.

And the reward which will be provided for such a one is salvation. But the opposite will happen there to the one who commits sin. [The one who commits] sin by himself [...] will be [in a ... in a ...] in order that before you (sg.) examine the one who <...>, one might [tell] another [about an] exalted power and a divine knowledge and a might which cannot be resisted. But you shall examine who is worthy that he should reveal them, knowing that [those] who commit sin [...] down to [...] as they [...] the Father ...] that which is fitting. Do not desire to give power to the sense-perceptible world. Are you (pl.) not attending to me, who have received salvation from the intelligible world? But (as for) these <words> — watch yourselves — do not [...] them as a(n) [...] understand ...] and he takes [...] the rest], I [will speak of] them. The [perfection ...] in order that it might increase [...] who commit sin [...] the embodied souls did not understand them. Those that are upon the earth as well as those outside of the body, those in heaven, are more than the angels. The place which we [talked] about in [every] discourse, these [...] stars [...] book(s) [...] whether already [...] into the [...] blessed is [...] whether he is gazing at the two or he is gazing at the seven planets or at the twelve signs of the Zodiac or at the thirty-six Decans [...] are [...] these reach up] to [...] and [these] numbers, whether [those in heaven] or those upon the earth, together with those that are under the [earth], according to the relationships and the divisions among these, and in the rest [...] parts [according to kind and] according to [species ... they] will [submit since] she has power [...] above [...] they exist apart [...]

... every [...] body(s) [...] a place [...] divine Barbelo ...] ... reveal them [...] in this [manner ...] this [...] intelligible angels], as she [...] intelligible [...] above ...] save(d) from [...] them [...] world [...] and [...] world ...] they came [...] those who [...] is [...] like [...] the voice of [...] name(s) [and ... for] ever [...] name(s) ...].

(pp. 47–54 missing)

[...] (after) I was silent, [I said], “Tell [me, ...] what is the [power ...] will wash [...] entire generation [...] greatly, the [...] much [...] he is [...], and [...] all [...] in the [...] knowledge ...] persevere [...] the great [...] for I [became ...] bone(s) of the [...] in the [worldly ...]”

(pp. 59–60 missing)

... which is] under [...] your daughters [...] for just as [...] the kingdom of [...]. But this one [...] every [...] in the one who [...] not. [And ...].

For it is [...] who [...] you (pl.) did not] know the [...] for the [...] partially ...] in [...] remainder down [...] the] earth. And they [spoke] like the angels [...] he was like the wild [animals]. And he said, [...] for] ever [...] from [...] the number [...] I saw [...] and his [...] a [voice ...] and [...] his [...]

... I [...] because I [saw] all of [the lights] around [me, blazing with] fire. [And ...] me in their midst [...] angel(s) [who ...] beside me. [And ...] the [one ...] Gamaliel, [the one] who is in command of [the spirits] which [...] the angels [...] which receive [all of them ...] with those whom they [...] and] he [took] me [...] he finished ...] her members [...] the [invisible ... judgment ...] thrown [...] every [...] which is placed ... fountain] of [immortality ...] living [...] the two [...]

silent ... god(s)] wash it (fem.) from [... of God ...] the one whom they [sealed] has been adorned
[with the seal of] heaven. [...] to his [...] great [...].

And I [saw ... unmixed ...] those who [...] they will become [...] of God [...] a woman [...] while she is in [travail ...] when she gives birth, [...] with [...] all of [...] thing [...] men [...] and [...] women [and men of this kind ... no one] of those [that are upon the] earth [knew] that [...] every [...] them, [and they will] take pity on these, [together with the] home-born, for these will [pay ...] God [...] acon(s) [...]

... with those who will [...] who have [...] God [...] from the [beginning ...] in [the ...] fear [... name(s) ... mysteries] in [...] God [...] manifest [...] those who will know [him].

[M]arsanes